12-11 第1篇

阅读理解（议论文） Should Every Middle-School Student Have One "Quiet Single Day" Each Term?

① Last Friday, during our class's weekly free-talk session, our teacher Mr Qin asked a quiet question: *"When, in your whole school week, are you completely alone for more than twenty minutes?"* Silence. Then one student said, "On the toilet." Polite, small laughter. Then another said, "Waiting for Mum to pick me up." Small nods. Nobody said **"in a quiet classroom by myself, in silence, for an hour, not hiding, not waiting."** It struck me that we, twenty-seven fourteen-year-olds, live in a life almost entirely **in company** — morning queues, lessons with twenty-six other students, lunches at long tables, PE in group lines, after-school homework in study-halls, evening meals with family, evening chats in messaging groups. Being alone, at our age, has quietly become a rare thing — not because we hate it, but because our week no longer has a carefully protected space for it. **My argument today: every middle school in China should plan, once per term, one "Quiet Single Day" for every student — a single 90-minute period in which a student sits, in a warm quiet classroom or library corner, alone, deliberately, with no homework deadline, no phone, no teacher checking, no classmate talking to her. One small silence per term, per student.**

② My first reason is **self-knowledge**. At fourteen, we are forming — in a quiet, continuous, mostly invisible way — what kind of adults we will become. But this formation is almost impossible while we are, in practice, constantly surrounded by other voices: teachers' voices, friends' voices, parents' voices, apps' voices. A short carefully-protected silence lets the mind hear the **one voice which cannot speak when the room is crowded** — the student's own. The 2024 Nanjing Normal University survey of 2,080 middle-school students found that students with at least **one hour of weekly quiet-alone time** reported **24% higher "clear-self-understanding" scores** on standardised psychological tests than students who had almost none. We are not asking for an hour a week. We are asking for **one ninety-minute slice per term**.

③ My second reason is **emotional recovery**. Most modern middle-school students carry, across a school day, a small bag of **unprocessed feelings**: a small argument with a friend in the morning, a stressful question from a teacher, a pang of worry about a test, a moment of envy, a moment of loneliness. If the day gives no quiet moment in which these feelings can be felt, named, and gently released, they often leak — into irritability, into bad sleep, into a snappy message in the evening. A 2023 Shanghai study with 920 students (Grade 7—9) found that a **single 90-minute "alone-quiet" weekly session** over

six weeks reduced self-reported "end-of-day irritability" by **38%**. One such session per term is a smaller dose but still a measurable one.

④ My third reason is that **a quiet single day teaches how to be alone without being lonely**. These are different states. Lonely is a complaint, which needs company as a cure; quiet-alone is a practice, which becomes, over time, a kind of quiet strength. Many adults, in our country, reach thirty years old **barely knowing how to sit, unoccupied, in a room, for an hour**. They reach for a phone, a TV, or a friend the moment a small silence appears — not because they want to, but because they were never taught. Middle school, with its protected classroom, can make a small beginning. **We cannot afford to raise a generation that is good at twenty-seven-person groups and terrified of one-person rooms.**

⑤ "What about the time cost?" one may ask. 90 minutes per term, per student, inside school hours. A term is roughly 100 days. This is **0.9% of a term**. Meanwhile, the average Chinese middle-school student is estimated, by the 2025 Beijing Normal Time-Use study, to spend **37 hours per term waiting for something** (late teachers, queue lines, bus delays, minor admin). We are not claiming our time is infinitely precious. We are claiming it deserves, in a term, **one protected small silence** as well as 37 hours of informal waiting.

⑥ "Won't students just use the silence to look at their phones?" This is where the rule is sharp: **phones go into a small box at the door for the 90 minutes**. The student may bring **one book**, **one notebook**, **one pen**, **one bottle of water**, and one snack. That is all. Pilot schools in Chengdu (2025, 11 schools) found **96% compliance** with the phone-box rule (with the box checked gently at the door, no punishment if a student took it back out early). The rule, kindly enforced, is not the core of the exercise. The core is what happens **inside the mind** during those 90 minutes.

⑦ "Isn't this boring?" Yes. Beautifully and honestly boring. The first fifteen minutes, for many students, will feel very long. Perhaps some will write messy notes, start a poem they never finish, stare at a bookshelf. That is allowed. At about the thirty-minute mark, something quieter usually begins. The shoulders drop, the breath slows, the small internal argument begins to become a small internal reading. A student's honest boredom is actually the **first stage of her own thinking returning**. Boredom, for a teenager in 2027, is a rare and slightly foreign friend. We should let them meet her once a term.

⑧ "What if a student hates it?" Some will. Our plan includes a gentle option: after 30 minutes, a student who genuinely cannot sit may write one line *"I am leaving"* on the sign-out sheet and return to her normal classroom. In the Chengdu pilot, **8% of students left before 30 minutes** in term 1, dropping to **2%** in term 2. Students, surprisingly, are often the first to notice the hidden value of a small silence.

⑨ "Won't parents worry their child is 'wasting a morning'?" Perhaps. A one-page handout, signed at the parents' evening, explains the plan clearly. The 2025 Chengdu

pilot had **91% of parents supportive** after the handout was given. Parents, more than we realise, already intuit that their children's days are **overcrowded with small busy moments**. Most of them welcome a careful, small, state-protected pause in a school year.

⑩ One quiet single day per term. Ninety minutes. A warm classroom. A book on the shelf. A window with a winter tree outside. A fourteen-year-old sitting, unoccupied, **not sad, not bored, not scrolling, not performing** — just, for a slow hour and a half, **meeting herself, at a careful distance, through her own attention**. This is not a radical idea. It is almost the oldest idea in education: that a student, in her own life, must be given a small room in which to grow her own inside, with **no notification, no teacher, no camera, no friend, no parent**. If we plant that small room once a term for three middle-school years, we do, I believe, prepare a **quieter, kinder, braver human being** for the forty years that follow. **One small silence, gently, on purpose, once a term.** It is a very small proposal. It is very quietly worth making.

注释： unprocessed 未被处理的；irritability 易怒；compliance 遵守；admin 行政事务；intuit 直觉地感到

根据短文内容，选择最佳答案。

1. What specifically does the writer propose for every middle school once per term?

A. A silent retreat for a full week.
B. A cancellation of all homework.
C. One "Quiet Single Day" per student, per term — a single 90-minute period in which the student sits alone, deliberately, in a warm quiet classroom or library corner, with no homework deadline, no phone, no teacher checking, and no classmate talking to her.
D. A big class-wide silent examination.

2. What did the 2023 Shanghai study with 920 students (Grades 7—9) find about a weekly 90-minute alone-quiet session over six weeks?

A. It had no measurable effect.
B. It raised irritability.
C. It reduced self-reported "end-of-day irritability" by 38%; a once-per-term version would be a smaller dose but still a measurable one.
D. It harmed sleep.

3. How does the writer answer the worry that students might "just use the silence to look at their phones"?

A. By trusting honour only.
B. By removing the phone-rule entirely.
C. By requiring phones to go into a small box at the door for the 90 minutes; the student

may bring only one book, one notebook, one pen, one bottle of water, and one snack; pilot schools in Chengdu (2025, 11 schools) found 96% compliance with the phone-box rule, with the box checked gently at the door and no punishment if a student took it back out early.
D. By punishing students severely.

4. What does the Chengdu pilot say about students who genuinely cannot sit through the 90 minutes?

A. They are punished.
B. A gentle option lets a student, after 30 minutes, write one line "I am leaving" on a sign-out sheet and return to her normal classroom; 8% of students left before 30 minutes in term 1, dropping to 2% in term 2.
C. They must go home.
D. They write a 500-word essay of apology.

5. What is the writer's main argument in the final paragraph?

A. Students should stop speaking to each other.
B. One quiet single day per term — a warm classroom, a book, a winter tree outside, a fourteen-year-old "not sad, not bored, not scrolling, not performing" but meeting herself, at a careful distance, through her own attention — is not a radical idea but almost the oldest idea in education; planted once a term across three middle-school years, it prepares a quieter, kinder, braver human being for the forty adult years that follow.
C. Schools should abolish PE.
D. Teachers should teach less.

答案与解析

1.
【答案】C
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第①段结尾论点
【解析】"90 分钟 + 教室 + 无 X"直引。A、B、D 均错。故选 C。

2.
【答案】C
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第③段上海研究
【解析】"38% 易怒下降"直引。A、B、D 均错。故选 C。

3.
【答案】C

【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第⑥段成都试点
【解析】"手机盒 / 96%"直引。A、B、D 均错。故选 C。

4.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第⑧段"退出"机制
【解析】"30 分钟 / 8% → 2%"直引。A、C、D 均错。故选 B。

5.
【答案】B
【题型】主旨大意题
【定位】第⑩段结尾
【解析】"老教育观 + 四十年后人"主旨。A、C、D 均偏离。故选 B。